had at least one mistress, the famously beautiful Rosamund Clifford. (William of Newburgh excuses this, pointing out that Henry was faithful until Eleanor hit menopause.) Once Geoffrey and Richard were safely with Henry the Younger, Eleanor herself prepared to flee from Poitiers to the court of Louis VII; reversing her path twenty years earlier from Paris to meet her bridegroom. Before she could get to Louis's lands, though, Henry II's men caught up with her, and Henry ordered her to be kept under guard in Chinon Castle. She would remain under house arrest for the next fifteen years, separated from contact with her sons.[9]

Widespread though the rebellion was, Henry II put it down briskly. The last major engagement was Louis VII's siege of Rouen, in Normandy, in August 1174. Henry, arriving with reinforcements, sent out a special force of Welsh mercenaries to cut off the French supply route through the woods, and the Welsh troops ("nimble and familiar with woodland," William of Newburgh observes) descended on supply trains, destroyed them, and then disappeared back into the forest. "The news was spread abroad that the woods were thronged with Welshmen," William tells us, and before long the French army lost heart. Louis VII, seeing the futility of fighting on, deserted his troops and retired to his capital, where he sent messages offering to come to terms. Geoffrey and Henry the Younger had already agreed to surrender to their father; only Richard was still holding out, laying siege to his father's castles in Poitou, his mother's native land. With Louis and his brothers deserting the cause, Richard was left with only a handful of men.[10]

Henry advanced into Poitou, forcing his son to retreat. By the end of September, Richard could no longer hold out. He went to his father's camp as a suppliant, threw himself on his face, and burst into tears.

In victory, Henry was relatively gracious. He restored most of the Western Francia territories to his sons (but continued to control them). The English nobles who had joined the revolt were, by and large, released and pardoned. Henry the Younger was forced to take a strict oath of homage to his father, and the status quo was—more or less—restored.

But the hostility between the king and his sons was not repaired; nor was the king of France reconciled.

IN 1180, LOUIS VII OF FRANCE died in Paris, aged sixty. The crown went to his fifteen-year-old son, Philip II Augustus; Louis's third wife, Adele of Champagne, had finally borne the French king his only male heir.

The young king's lands were circled around by noble estates, ruled by powerful French dukes: Flanders, Burgundy, Toulouse. Louis VII had ruled as monarch only in the territory immediately around Paris; in the farther reaches